

Matthew Beardwell

Watford, Hertfordshire · contact@mbeardwell.com · mbeardwell.com

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · [TryHackMe](#)

Professional Summary

Security Analyst with strengths in digital forensics and OSINT. Experience includes ARM instruction patching and binary analysis. Recovered deleted data and artefacts in both lab-based and real-world contexts. Completed 116 hands-on labs (~100 hrs, Top 2% TryHackMe) and earned a First-Class BSc in Computer Science from King's College London. Currently preparing for CompTIA Security+.

Technical Skills

- **Scripting and Programming:** Python, Bash, C, ARM Assembly
- **Networking:** Wireshark, TCP/IP analysis, PCAP inspection
- **Forensics:** Autopsy, dd, foremost, photorec, scalpel; disk image recovery and file carving
- **OSINT:** Identity/location tracing, metadata correlation, client investigations, toolkit authoring
- **Reverse Engineering:** GDB, IDA Free, Ghidra, radare2, ARM runtime patching

Cybersecurity Projects

ActiveReconLite · Python Port Scanner

FEB 2025 – MAR 2025

Built a Python-based TCP connect port scanner using multiprocessing. Outperforms Nmap in some cases by 60x; scanned 65k ports in 5s (vs Nmap's 5m). It validates user input, grabs banners, and writes results to a file. Demonstrates automation, socket programming, and parallel scanning. github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite

Location and Identity Resolution from Minimal Public Signals · OSINT Case Study

APR 2025

Tracked real-world identity from anonymised YouTube uploads using public data. Shows attacker thinking, threat profiling, and privacy risk awareness. Demonstrates threat intelligence process fundamentals: collection, enrichment, analysis, and attribution based on minimal public indicators. github.com/mbeardwell/osint-i3-case-study

UK Person-centric OSINT Toolkit

JUN 2025

Curation of UK-only, legal person-focused OSINT resources for investigative use. Featured by "Learn Cybersecurity" Telegram channel (27k subscribers); 100+ LinkedIn/Substack clicks in 1 week.

github.com/mbeardwell/uk-personal-osint-toolkit

Faster Dynamically Instrumented Programs · Bachelor's Thesis

OCT 2022 – MAY 2023

Developed PoC mimicking evasive malware behaviour by changing programs in memory at the lowest level.

github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu

Professional Experience

OSINT Investigator · Freelance & Self-Led

MAY 2023 – APR 2025

Conducted multiple open-ended OSINT investigations for clients, including one extensively documented case study. Also independently executed identity and geolocation tracing projects.

Maths Tutor · Freelance

SEP 2016 – NOV 2019

Tutored students aged 9–13 in maths (11+ and GCSE prep).

Research and Documentation Intern · Indo UK Institute of Health

JUN 2017 – AUG 2017

Researched benefits/partnerships and edited exec-level strategy docs for a billion-pound healthcare initiative.

Education and Certifications

Security Training · TryHackMe

FEB 2022 – PRESENT

Completed 116 hands-on labs (~100 hrs) that included digital forensics, OSINT, and reverse engineering. Ranked in the Top 2% globally.

BSc (Hons) CS · King's College London

First-Class

SEP 2018 – JUL 2023

A-Levels · King's Maths School

A* A* A* A*

SEP 2016 – JUL 2018

CompTIA

Security+

(IN PROGRESS)

TryHackMe

Intro to Cyber Security

FEB 2024

Security Blue Team

Intro to OSINT

JUN 2025

TryHackMe

Pre-Security

APR 2022

Prince's Trust

TEAM (12-week programme incl. First Aid)

JAN 2024 – APR 2024